Basic Karate Handbook

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Chapter 1: Strikes

The straight punch (oi-zuki) is the fundamental attack of karate. Step forward and drive the fist from the hip, twisting at the end. Practice it daily against the opponent's centre line. The reverse punch (gyaku-zuki) throws the rear hand while the front leg stays planted; it is the most powerful strike for a counter attack.

Chapter 2: Kicks

The front kick (mae-geri) raises the knee and snaps the ball of the foot into the opponent's stomach. The roundhouse kick (mawashi-geri) swings the shin or instep in an arc toward the head or ribs. The side kick (yoko-geri) thrusts the edge of the foot sideways and is a strong attack against a charging opponent.

Chapter 3: Blocks

The rising block (age-uke) lifts the forearm to deflect a strike aimed at the face. The outside block (soto-uke) sweeps the forearm across the body to parry a punch to the chest. The downward block (gedan-barai) sweeps down to deflect a front kick. Every block should flow into a counter.

Chapter 4: Evasion

Body shifting (tai-sabaki) is the best defense: step off the line of the attack and turn so the opponent's strike misses. The knife-hand block (shuto-uke) defends while setting up a counter strike. An elbow strike (empi-uchi) is an attack for close range when the opponent grabs you.